



Course report for AG2500 Spring term 2025

The 2025 IAGG thesis course registered 42 students, of which 14 were reregistered students from previous years who had not yet completed their thesis, and 28 were from the graduating cohort. 3 additional students wrote their thesis at Fudan, within the framework of the double degree program. Of the 42 enrolled students, 30 completed their thesis (either in May or September 2025, or February 2026). The grade distribution was 8 High Pass and 22 Pass. The remaining students have either not submitted or were encouraged to withdraw their thesis, continue revising and resubmit at a later submission opportunity.

The course had the same structure as in previous years. Two rounds of preparatory seminars are held in December and January, and there are three opportunities to submit per year: in May, September and February.

In terms of examination, theses are screened and if significant problems are detected, students are encouraged to withdraw the thesis, to continue working and to resubmit at a later point in time. Each thesis is then evaluated by a main and secondary examiner, discussed at a seminar by both a student discussant and the main examiner, and then discussed at a meeting with all the examiners after the seminars. Students then receive written comments in a grading sheet, which also indicates the grade.

In an effort to reduce uncertainty regarding finding a supervisor, the course guide was revised to better explain the process. The course guide was also revised to clarify the following points:

- The screening process (some students had not understood it would take place),
- That grades are not posted directly after the seminar but rather after a week.
- More detail on what distinguishes a Pass from a High Pass.
- Clearer statement of the word count limit
- The necessary components of a good thesis, e.g. what the methods section needs to cover, the role of a theoretical framework, the importance of attention to alternative explanations, the importance of discussing the limitations in one's own data and analysis.
- Information about what is a reasonable number of meetings with a supervisor and how to best structure the work: Plan the goals and time for the next meeting.